

SIMATS ENGINEERING

ASSESSMENT TOOL 3 – VIVA QUESTIONS

COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

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CO5: Analyze vulnerabilities in Windows and Linux systems and evaluate security weaknesses in

messaging, web, and mobile applications using appropriate exploitation techniques and hacking tools. (BT5)

Code of Conduct:

I K.PUJITHA(Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work

and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment. I understand that any violation of academic

Signature of the student:

6. How would you distinguish between a vulnerable Windows service and a misconfigured Windows service during security testing?

Answer:

A vulnerable service has a weakness in the software itself, while a misconfigured service has incorrect or insecure settings. I would check the service version for known vulnerabilities and then check its permissions and configuration.

Easy to remember:

Vulnerable = Software problem

Misconfigured = Settings problem

7. How would you evaluate the effectiveness of information-gathering techniques against a Windows target?

Answer:

I would check how much useful and accurate information was collected about the Windows system. I would look at users, services, open ports, shares, and operating system details. This information helps identify possible security weaknesses.

Easy to remember:

Information → Accuracy → Services → Users → Security weaknesses

8. If a Windows vulnerability can be exploited but requires local access, how would you classify its security impact compared with a remotely exploitable vulnerability?**Answer:**

A local vulnerability requires the attacker to already have access to the system. A remote vulnerability can be exploited through a network without local access. Therefore, a remote vulnerability generally has greater exposure, but the final severity depends on its impact.

Easy to remember:

Local = Requires access

Remote = Network access

Remote usually has greater exposure

9. How would you evaluate the security risks of unconnected or unnecessary services running on a Linux system?**Answer:**

I would identify all running services and check which ones are unnecessary. Unnecessary services increase the attack surface and may provide opportunities for attackers. I would disable services that are not required and restrict access to necessary services.

Easy to remember:

Find services → Check necessity → Attack surface → Disable unnecessary services

10. Why are rhosts and hosts.equiv considered security risks in Linux? How would you evaluate their impact on system security?**Answer:**

rhosts and hosts.equiv use trust between systems instead of strong authentication. If they are

incorrectly configured, unauthorized users may gain access. I would check which systems are trusted and remove unnecessary trust relationships.

Easy to remember:

Trust → Weak authentication → Unauthorized access → Remove unnecessary trust